STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3431
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED **06/01/06**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT DEATHS	CROSS REFERENCE P-3430 RESCUE CALLS P-3433 CORONER CALLS P-4810 CRIME SCENES I-3110 ON-CALL INVESTIGATOR I-3300 DEATH INVESTIGATIONS			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for deputies responding to calls related to deaths and discoveries of dead bodies.

II. Policy:

Any call for service regarding a possible death or the discovery of a dead body shall be treated, initially, as a homicide by the responding patrol deputy.

III. Procedures:

A. Deaths-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies shall determine if the scene is safe to enter and secure to allow emergency medical personnel to respond.

2. Upon arrival, the deputy shall determine the status of the victim and render any aid, if required. If the individual is not deceased:

a) The deputy should attempt to protect the scene while allowing emergency medical personnel to treat the victim.

b) Point out potential physical evidence to medical personnel; instruct them to minimize contact with such evidence (e.g., Ensure that medical personnel preserve all clothing and personal effects without cutting through bullet holes, knife tears etc.); and document movement of persons or items by medical personnel.

c) If medical personnel arrived prior to the deputy, the deputy shall gather the names, telephone numbers, and work information for all medical personnel who entered the scene.

d) If it is apparent that the individual was a victim of a crime, the deputy, if possible, should accompany the victim in the rescue squad and stay with the victim. The deputy should record any statements made by the victim in case of a possible dying declaration.

3. The deputy shall attempt to determine if the death was a result of a crime and, if so, identify and apprehend the suspect.

4. If the deputy determines the victim is deceased, he or she may escort **one** emergency medical responder into the crime scene to complete a medical assessment of death. Once the medical assessment has been completed the deputy shall escort the medical responder out of the scene.

5. The deputy shall protect the scene from alteration and contamination (see P-4810 Crime Scene).

6. The deputy shall identify and secure any possible witnesses. The deputy shall obtain initial information and statements.

7. The first responding deputy shall be responsible for the scene and shall not leave the scene until relieved by a supervisor or an investigator. The initial deputy shall brief the supervisor and/or investigator.

8. The first responding deputy shall complete an incident report including:

a) Observations of the crime scene to include the location of individuals and items within the scene.

b) Conditions upon arrival (e.g., lights on/off; shades up/down; doors and windows open/closed; smells; temperature; personal items; etc.).

c) Personal information from witnesses, victims, suspects and any statements or comments made.

d) The deputy's actions and actions of others.

9. Deputies shall also complete a First Responder Duty Checklist.

B. Deaths-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. An on-duty shift supervisor shall respond to all deaths.

2. The supervisor shall determine the need for a death investigation. (see P-3433 Coroner Calls).

3. If a death investigation is warranted, the supervisor shall:

a) Notify the on-call investigator.

b) The supervisor shall also notify the watch commander or ADC.

c) Secure the scene (see P-4810 Crime Scene)